

AstraNova Technologies Pvt. Ltd. — Master HR & Security FAQ Collection

This document is a comprehensive, centralized data asset for the AI-Powered HR Policy Intelligence Assistant and all company staff. It provides clear, straightforward answers using simple language to address 60 common employee questions covering all company policies.

Part 1: Attendance, Hours, and Shift Management

Q1: What are the core collaboration hours I must follow?

A1: You must be online and available on Slack between 11:00 AM and 4:00 PM IST, Monday through Friday.

Q2: What is the total number of hours required in a standard work week?

A2: A standard work week requires a total of 40 hours of active duty, spread across 5 working days.

Q3: What should I do if the biometric machine at the Pune office fails to read my card?

A3: Use the HRIS portal on your phone for a web check-in, then open an IT ticket to fix your card.

Q4: By what time must I report an unplanned morning absence to my manager?

A4: You must notify your reporting manager via email or Slack by 10:00 AM IST at the latest.

Q5: What counts as a late arrival under company policy?

A5: Any initial daily log-in or office biometric punch after 11:00 AM IST counts as a late arrival.

:Q6: How many unexcused late arrivals trigger a formal review?

A6: The system allows three late arrivals per month. A fourth instance triggers a formal manager review.

Q7: What is the deadline to clear a missed attendance punch in the system?

A7: You must submit an attendance regularization request via the HRIS portal within 3 working days.

Q8: What happens if I leave an attendance gap unresolved past the payroll cutoff?

A8: The system will automatically mark that unresolved gap as a Loss of Pay (LOP) day.

Q9: Are the 11:00 AM to 4:00 PM core hours identical for the 24/7 technical support teams?

A9: No. SRE and support teams follow rotating 8-hour rosters set by their Department Head.

Q10: Can I work on weekends to make up for hours missed during the week?

A10: No. Weekend work cannot replace missed core hours unless your Department Head gives written approval.

Part 2: Hybrid and Remote Work Protocols

Q11: What is the standard hybrid work requirement at AstraNova?

A11: You must work from the physical Pune headquarters for a minimum of two days every week.

Q12: Can I choose any two days of the week to work from the office?

A12: You must coordinate with your specific team lead to match your team's set in-office days.

Q13: Can I use my personal desktop computer to work from home?

A13: No. You must only use the official secure laptop provided by the Company for all tasks.

Q14: What is the minimum internet speed required for remote work?

A14: You must have a stable home internet connection with a minimum speed of 50 Mbps.

Q15: Can I work from a coffee shop or a public park using their Wi-Fi?

A15: No. Working from public areas on open Wi-Fi is banned due to data leak risks.

Q16: Do I need to turn on my camera during internal team video calls?

A16: Yes. Keeping your camera turned on is mandatory for all team syncs and client meetings.

Q17: What should I do if my home internet goes out during core hours?

A17: Call your manager immediately. If it takes over two hours to fix, you may need to travel to the office.

Q18: Can I work from home full-time if I move to a different city?

A18: Full-time remote work is not standard and requires special written approval from your Department Head and HR.

Q19: Can I share my work laptop with family members to check their email?

A19: No. Your company laptop is for your exclusive professional use only. Never share it with anyone.

Q20: Can I work from home while I am placed on a Performance Improvement Plan (PIP)?

A20: No. Remote work privileges are paused during a PIP. You must work on-site at the Pune office for close guidance.

Part 3: Leaves, Time-Off, and Accruals

Q21: How many days of Casual Leave (CL) do I get each year?

A21: Permanent employees receive 12 days of Casual Leave per calendar year, credited on January 1.

Q22: Do my unused Casual Leaves carry forward to the next year?

A22: No. All unused Casual Leaves lapse completely on December 31 and cannot be carried forward.

Q23: How many days of Privilege Leave (PL) do I earn each year?

A23: You earn 18 days of Privilege Leave per year, which accumulate at a rate of 1.5 days per month.

Q24: What is the maximum number of Privilege Leaves I can accumulate?

A24: You can carry forward up to 30 days of PL. Any balance above 30 days will lapse on December 31.

Q25: Can I combine Casual Leave and Privilege Leave for a single long vacation?

A25: No. Company rules state that Casual Leave cannot be combined with Privilege Leave or Sick Leave.

Q26: How much advance notice do I need to give for a planned vacation using PL?

A26: You must submit your Privilege Leave request in the HRIS portal at least 2 weeks in advance.

Q27: Do I need a medical slip if I take a two-day Sick Leave?

A27: No. A medical certificate is only required if your Sick Leave lasts for more than 2 consecutive days.

Q28: How many weeks of paid Maternity Leave does the company provide?

A28: Eligible female employees receive 26 weeks of fully paid Maternity Leave per statutory rules.

Q29: What is the entitlement for Paternity Leave at AstraNova?

A29: Eligible male employees receive 2 weeks of paid Paternity Leave, to be used within six months of the birth.

Q30: What is Bereavement Leave and how many days do I get?

A30: You get up to 5 paid days off if an immediate family member passes away. This does not lower your regular leave balance.

Part 4: Payroll, Allowances, and Tax Compliance

Q31: On what day of the month is my salary paid?

A31: Monthly salaries are deposited into your corporate bank account on the last working day of each month.

Q32: What is the monthly attendance cut-off date for payroll processing?

A32: The payroll cut-off date is the 25th of each month. Logs updated after this date move to the next month.

Q33: How can I view or download my monthly payslip?

A33: You can view or download your digital payslip directly from your personal dashboard in the HRIS portal.

Q34: Does the company provide a home internet allowance?

A34: Yes. You can claim a monthly broadband bill refund via the HRIS portal up to your role's set limit.

Q35: When must I submit my final income tax investment proofs?

A35: You must upload all final verified investment proofs to the HRIS portal by January 15.

Q36: What happens if I miss the January 15 tax proof deadline?

A36: The system will calculate your tax without those savings, causing a higher TDS deduction in February and March.

Q37: What percentage of my total salary makes up the Basic Salary component?

A37: The Basic Salary is set between 40% and 50% of your total Gross Salary package.

Q38: Can I change my Flexible Benefits Plan (FBP) choices mid-year?

A38: No. FBP choices can only be selected once a year in April and remain locked for the rest of the financial year.

Q39: When will I receive my annual Form 16 for tax filing?

A39: The finance team releases digital Form 16 certificates on or before June 15 of every year.

Q40: Can I get an advance on my salary for personal shopping?

A40: No. The company does not offer salary advances for personal spending.

Part 5: Performance Appraisals and Career Progression

Q41: How often are formal performance reviews conducted?

A41: Formal reviews happen once a year in April. We also hold a mid-year tracking check-in every October.

Q42: What is the minimum service time needed to qualify for the annual appraisal?

A42: You must complete at least six months of continuous service within the current financial year.

Q43: What does a Rating 3 mean in the performance scale?

A43: Rating 3 means you fully meet expectations, fulfill your job duties, and hit your team sprint goals.

Q44: What happens if an employee receives a Rating 2 (Needs Improvement)?

A44: A Rating 2 triggers a formal review and places the employee on a structured 60-day Performance Improvement Plan.

Q45: How long does a standard Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) last?

A45: A standard corporate PIP lasts for a fixed period of 60 days with clear weekly output targets.

Q46: What happens if someone does not meet their PIP targets by day 60?

A46: If the documented PIP targets are not met, the Company reserves the right to terminate employment.

Q47: What is the minimum time I must spend in my role before I can get a promotion?

A47: You must complete a minimum of twelve months of continuous service in your current grade or role.

Q48: Can I apply for an open job role in a different department?

A48: Yes. You can use the Internal Job Posting (IJP) system if you have been in your current role for 12 months.

Q49: Can I contest my performance rating if I disagree with my manager?

A49: Yes. You can file a formal appraisal appeal in the HRIS portal within 5 working days of your review meeting.

Q50: Does the company refund the cost of technical AI certifications?

A50: Yes. If the certification is on the approved company list, you can upload your certificate for a full cost refund.

Part 6: Code of Conduct, Ethics, and Security

Q51: Can I take a weekend freelance coding job if it is outside my official hours?

A51: No. AstraNova strictly bans moonlighting or taking any side-employment in the tech or AI sector.

Q52: What is the maximum gift value I can accept from a client or vendor?

A52: You can only accept small corporate promotional items worth less than INR 2,000.

Q53: Can I post details about my active client project frameworks on LinkedIn?

A53: No. Sharing internal project code, frameworks, or client names on personal social accounts is strictly banned.

Q54: Can I paste work code into a public web AI tool to look for bugs?

A54: No. Pasting company code or data into public AI websites is banned. You must use our secure internal AI tools.

Q55: Who should I contact if I think my work laptop has a virus or security breach?

A55: Send an email alert to security@astranova.com or call the internal IT security hotline immediately.

Q56: How often does the system force me to change my network password?

A56: You must update your main account password every 90 days to keep the network secure.

Q57: Can I plug a personal USB thumb drive into my company laptop to copy files?

A57: No. The IT team blocks external storage devices on all work laptops to prevent data leaks.

Q58: Will my identity be kept secret if I report a conduct rule break?

A58: Yes. All whistleblower profiles and report details are kept private to ensure you feel safe sharing the issue.

Q59: Can I install a personal messaging app or game on my work computer?

A59: No. Downloading unapproved software, games, or chat apps on company laptops is strictly against policy.

Q60: Can I refer a family member for an open job position at AstraNova?

A60: Yes, through our standard referral system. However, you cannot be part of their interview panel or act as their manager.